excitement the next day. My wife and children were with me at that time, it being the summer break, and they got caught up in the excitement too. This was something straight out of a 007 movie. At the appointed time, Narendra was hovering near the gate, ensuring that nothing should spook Samra at the last moment. No extra security or too vigorous checking of passers-by. I stayed close to the phone, in case of any last-minute change of plans. Everything went off smoothly and by early afternoon, Samra was in our custody. We debriefed him in detail but the question was what we should do with him. This was too important a matter to await the routine evening report, so I rang up the Sector Commander and the GOC. The GOC felt that we should try and turn him—make him a double agent. Release him back into the environment and establish a secure mode of communication through which Samra could give us hard, actionable intelligence of terrorists, based on which we could launch surgical, people-friendly operations, avoiding the tedium of long-drawn cordon and search operations.

It was a big risk to take, to release a graded terrorist who was already in the bag, back into the populace. Suppose he carried out some spectacular terrorist action resulting in massive casualties while pretending to work for us? It would be unforgivable. But the more we spoke with him, the more we realized that the fight had gone out of him. Our relentless chasing of call sign Samra had worn him down. Twice he had escaped by the skin of his teeth. He knew it was only a matter of time before he was captured or worse, killed. His coming over to us was therefore greatly as a result of our relentless efforts. He had also fallen in love with a local girl (whom he later married), and it was she who had motivated him to surrender. Moreover, he confessed that after seeing that way of life, he had realized how all the indoctrination that they had been given, of

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